

# Thornbridge Retail Group plc

## Total Reward Strategy & Plan

What we intend our reward to do, where it sits against that intent, and the plan to close the difference.

**8**

### AREAS BENCHMARKED

against All peers

**10**

### COMMITMENTS OFF STRATEGY

8 short or contradicted · 2 past a deliberately lower aim

**1**

### ACTION PROPOSED THIS CYCLE

see What we're asking

#### ORGANISATION

Retail & Consumer Goods · 50–249 FTE

#### DATE OF ISSUE

17 Aug 2026

#### DOCUMENT STATUS

Version 1 — amended 15 Aug 2026; re-approval pending

#### BENCHMARK BASIS

All peers

#### COMPARISON POOL

270 UK organisation profiles — lumih.co.uk methodology

#### DATA COLLECTION

2026 H1 · 11 Jun 2026

#### STATED PEER GROUP

5 sectors · 10,000+, 1,000–4,999 FTE — not the basis for the reads in this document; see Method and basis

#### PRIMARY OBJECTIVE

Attract

#### CLASSIFICATION

Private & confidential

## 01

## Executive summary

The position, the ask and the basis, in one page.

Read against a strategy focused on attracting the people you need, 4 areas sit below market against the position you set.

### WHAT THIS PAPER CONCLUDES

Your strategy sets a position for 6 of the 8 benchmarked areas and makes 7 coherence commitments besides — 13 in all, listed with their status in The commitments in full. 10 are off strategy; 3 hold. The board is asked to re-approve the strategy as amended, then approve the action scheduled for this cycle. The one envelope lumi can price — closing every priced gap to the peer median — is £27,000 a year; it is not the cost of this approval.

### CONTENTS

|                                           |           |                                       |           |
|-------------------------------------------|-----------|---------------------------------------|-----------|
| 01 Executive summary                      | 2         | 12 Health & protection                | 20        |
| 02 What we're asking the board to approve | 3         | 13 Benefits & lifestyle               | 21        |
| 03 Method and basis                       | 4         | 14 Time off & family                  | 24        |
| <b>Part A — The reward strategy</b>       | <b>5</b>  | 15 Incentives & recognition           | 25        |
| 04 The strategy                           | 6         | 16 Wellbeing                          | 27        |
| 05 How we position reward                 | 8         | 17 Governance & transparency          | 29        |
| 06 Tensions and what to watch             | 9         | <b>Part C — What follows</b>          | <b>31</b> |
| <b>Part B — Where the package stands</b>  | <b>10</b> | 18 The schedule                       | 32        |
| 07 Position at a glance                   | 11        | 19 The plan                           | 34        |
| 08 The commitments in full                | 12        | 20 What it costs                      | 35        |
| 09 Findings                               | 14        | 21 What a point is worth              | 36        |
| 10 Pay                                    | 16        | 22 Risks and exposures                | 37        |
| 11 Pensions & savings                     | 18        | <b>Part D — Governance and method</b> | <b>38</b> |
|                                           |           | 23 Governance and approval            | 38        |

## 02

## What we're asking the board to approve

The decision this paper seeks, what it would cost, and what it deliberately leaves open.

### DECISION SOUGHT

**Re-approve the strategy as amended, then approve the action scheduled for this cycle**

The board — or the remuneration committee, where reward is delegated to it — is asked for two decisions. First, re-approve the strategy as amended — the gaps below are measured against it. Second, approve the 1 action scheduled for this cycle, covering Benefits & lifestyle. The action itself carries no new recurring spend. It is the first step of a response to the 10 gaps this review found between the strategy as stated and the organisation's own data, of which one is acted on now. Separately, the indicative cost of closing every gap lumi can price is £27,000 a year — that envelope covers 1 of the 10 gaps and is not the cost of this approval.

1

#### ACTION THIS CYCLE

Benefits & lifestyle

£27,000

#### ALL PRICED GAPS, A YEAR

the envelope, not this approval's cost  
— see What it costs

10

#### GAPS IN SCOPE

strategy vs your own data

#### What approval covers

- Voluntary benefits platform

#### What it does not cover

The 9 gaps no action is proposed against are set out under their own areas with the options against them, and are not part of this approval. Where an option is already planned it appears in The schedule; the rest fall to the next review.

### WHAT APPROVAL SETS IN MOTION

#### Re-approve

the strategy as amended



#### Approve

the actions for this cycle



#### Deliver

changes land in the package



#### Re-measure

the next collection window



#### Movement

reported against this baseline

## 03

## Method and basis

How every figure in this document was produced, what it rests on, and what it deliberately does not claim.

### COMPLETENESS

This document rests on 74 of the 77 core-set questions (96%). An area with too few benchmarked metrics for a firm verdict carries an indicative read, marked in its own section; unanswered areas say so rather than being estimated.

### DATA VINTAGE

Peer figures are the 2026 H1 collection, dated 11 Jun 2026. Your own answers are as you last saved them. The strategy names 5 sectors · 10,000+, 1,000–4,999 FTE as its stated peer group; no read here uses it — they run on All peers, and its size bands are not your own (50–249 FTE).

### HOW POSITIONS ARE COMPUTED

Positions come from your own submitted data against All peers, on the engine and suppression rules that govern every figure in lumi — no figure rests on fewer than 5 organisations. An area's verdict weighs every metric's position; its percentile is depth alone — near the band's edge the two can differ. Alignment is a count against your commitments — never a score, index or grade.

### WHAT IT WILL NOT DO

Positions blend your whole workforce, so a blended percentile can mask offsetting gaps between populations; this document does not split them.

Where a commitment's evidence is unanswered, this document says so rather than estimating: 0 commitments sit unevidenced today. Indicative figures come from lumi's cost model on its published assumptions, only where it has one for the area. Every written passage here is lumi's standard wording, composed from the figures on the page — no model output was used.

The strategy here is yours as you stated it; the position is your own data read against the comparison pool; the options are what the market commonly does, and every decision among them stays with you. Where lumi could not see something, it has said so.



## PART A

# The reward strategy

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What this organisation intends its reward to do, the positions it has chosen, and the principles and constraints those choices sit inside. Nothing in this part is a measurement — every position here is a stated intention.

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|                               |   |
|-------------------------------|---|
| 04 The strategy               | 6 |
| 05 How we position reward     | 8 |
| 06 Tensions and what to watch | 9 |

## 04

## The strategy

The strategy as the organisation states it. Every position here is a choice; nothing on these two pages is a measurement.

### Purpose and context

Thornbridge Retail Group plc sets out its approach to reward in this document so that pay and benefit decisions are made against a stated position rather than case by case. The focus this year is attracting the people it needs, and the choices below are made in service of that. The organisation compares itself to 5 sectors · 10,000+, 1,000–4,999 FTE.

### Our reward philosophy

The organisation has not written down a separate set of reward principles. The positions stated below carry the philosophy in their place: each one is a deliberate choice about the kind of employer Thornbridge Retail Group plc intends to be.

### How we position against the market

Thornbridge Retail Group plc aims to sit above market on reward overall. This is a position the organisation has chosen, not a description of where it currently sits. Within that stance, some areas are set differently: Time off & family is aimed below market, Benefits & lifestyle is aimed in line with the market, Health & protection is aimed in line with the market, Pensions & savings is aimed in line with the market, Pay is aimed below market and Incentives & recognition is aimed above market.

## 04

## The strategy (cont.)

Continued: how the package is shaped, how performance is differentiated, and how reward is governed and communicated.

### The shape of the package

The package is led by base pay, with benefits playing a supporting role. Family provision is deliberately more generous than the market. On benefits, the organisation intends to lead on financial wellbeing and mental wellbeing. Pay is the same wherever people are based.

### Performance and differentiation

On performance, stronger performance earns a measured premium. The organisation's position on timing is that it is willing to move early. Budget direction for the coming cycle is one of investment.

### Transparency and governance

Pay information is fully open. Reward positions are set by the organisation's Admins in lumi and reviewed when the strategy is revisited; the approval record for this document is set out at the end of it.

## 05

## How we position reward

Each dial below is a stated choice, not a measurement. The third column is what that choice changes in how every benchmark in this document is read.

**EXHIBIT 1** Stated reward positions, and what each one changes in how the benchmark is read

| DIMENSION           | OUR POSITION                                       | WHAT IT DRIVES                                                   |
|---------------------|----------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Market position     | <b>Above market</b><br>6 areas carry their own aim | The position every area is read against.                         |
| Total-reward mix    | <b>Mostly pay</b>                                  | How pay and wider benefits are weighed together.                 |
| Pay for performance | <b>Some gap</b>                                    | The spread between individuals that is treated as intended.      |
| Pay transparency    | <b>Fully open</b>                                  | Which openness practices count as commitments.                   |
| Location approach   | <b>Anywhere</b>                                    | Whether local pay markets are read separately.                   |
| Benefits lead       | <b>Leads on financial, mental wellbeing</b>        | The benefit areas treated as deliberate leads.                   |
| Family-friendliness | <b>Generous</b>                                    | The family-support bar the organisation is held to.              |
| Primary objective   | <b>Attract</b>                                     | The lens the whole document is read through.                     |
| Budget direction    | <b>Investing</b>                                   | Whether saving or investment is weighed more heavily.            |
| Acute pressure      | <b>Business as usual</b>                           | The operating condition the year's choices are made in.          |
| Risk appetite       | <b>Move early</b>                                  | How early the organisation expects to move on emerging practice. |



06

## Tensions and what to watch

Where the stated strategy pulls against itself, or against what the data shows.

### THE CONTRADICTIONS ON THE REGISTER

Pay is described as fully open, and pay is never included in job adverts (Never, your response).

Pay information is stated as shared internally, and pay bands are not visible to employees (No, your response).

The stated objective is attracting the people you need, and pay — the part of the package a candidate weighs first — is aimed below market. The two intents pull in opposite directions, and the employer brand is left doing the work pay is declining to do.

Each is a stated intent your own answers run against — not a shortfall in delivery — and is carried with its evidence in The commitments in full.

### TENSIONS

7 areas sit away from your stated intent — Pay, Pensions & savings, Benefits & lifestyle, Time off & family, Incentives & recognition, Wellbeing and Governance & transparency. In each, where you are and where you said you would be do not yet agree.

### WHAT TO WATCH

Your stated focus this year is attracting the people you need — the first thing to watch is whether the areas that serve it hold their stated position.



## PART B

# Where the package stands

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The live benchmark for each area of reward, read against the position the strategy sets for it. One section per area: the evidence behind the read, the market position it produces, what the area is flagging, and how the two compare.

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|                              |    |
|------------------------------|----|
| 07 Position at a glance      | 11 |
| 08 The commitments in full   | 12 |
| 09 Findings                  | 14 |
| 10 Pay                       | 16 |
| 11 Pensions & savings        | 18 |
| 12 Health & protection       | 20 |
| 13 Benefits & lifestyle      | 21 |
| 14 Time off & family         | 24 |
| 15 Incentives & recognition  | 25 |
| 16 Wellbeing                 | 27 |
| 17 Governance & transparency | 29 |

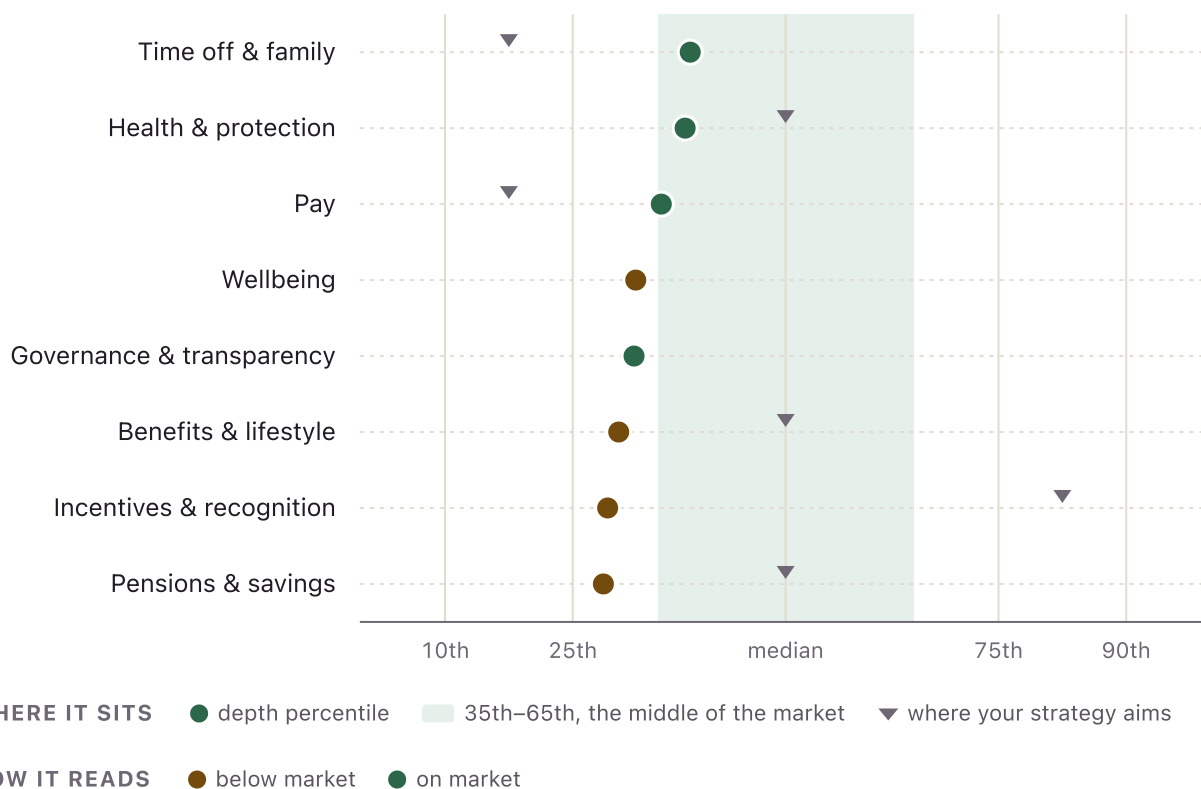
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07

## Position at a glance

Each area's live benchmark on All peers, read against the position the strategy states for it.

**EXHIBIT 2** Market position of every area on one percentile scale, ranked by depth percentile, with the position the strategy sets for each



Two different measures, deliberately. Where a dot sits is the area's depth percentile. What colour it is, is the verdict across every metric in that area — not just the percentile. So the two can disagree: an area can sit outside the middle band and still read on market. Both are shown because both are true, and a reader deciding on one alone would be reading half the picture.

The chart above covers the 8 areas lumi benchmarks. Elsewhere this document counts COMMITMENTS — an area carries one for the position your strategy sets, plus one for each coherence check that applies to it — so 10 off strategy, 3 holding and 0 not yet evidenced are a different measure of the same picture, not a disagreement.

## 08

## The commitments in full (1 of 2)

One row per commitment — the register behind every count in this paper: 13 stated, 10 off strategy, 3 holding.

**EXHIBIT 3** Every commitment, its status and its evidence (1 of 2)

| AREA                     | COMMITMENT                                                                                                                                                      | STATUS                         | READ FROM                |
|--------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------|
| Pay                      | You aim below market on Pay; the live read sits past it — spend beyond the stated position.                                                                     | <b>Past the stated aim</b>     | Market read on All peers |
| Pensions & savings       | You aim on market on Pensions & savings; the live read sits short of it.                                                                                        | <b>Short of the stated aim</b> | Market read on All peers |
| Health & protection      | You aim on market on Health & protection; the live read matches it.                                                                                             | <b>Holding</b>                 | Market read on All peers |
| Benefits & lifestyle     | You aim on market on Benefits & lifestyle; the live read sits short of it.                                                                                      | <b>Short of the stated aim</b> | Market read on All peers |
| Time off & family        | You aim below market on Time off & family; the live read sits past it — spend beyond the stated position.                                                       | <b>Past the stated aim</b>     | Market read on All peers |
| Incentives & recognition | You aim above market on Incentives & recognition; the live read sits short of it.                                                                               | <b>Short of the stated aim</b> | Market read on All peers |
| Pay                      | Stated: cash-led reward mix — your responses are consistent with it.                                                                                            | <b>Holding</b>                 | Your stated answers      |
| Pay                      | Stated: location-agnostic pay — your responses are consistent with it.                                                                                          | <b>Holding</b>                 | Your stated answers      |
| Benefits & lifestyle     | The package is stated to lead on financial wellbeing, and neither a financial-wellbeing programme nor default salary-sacrifice pension shows in your responses. | <b>Short of the stated aim</b> | Your stated answers      |

08

## The commitments in full (2 of 2)

**EXHIBIT 4** Every commitment, its status and its evidence (2 of 2)

| AREA                      | COMMITMENT                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | STATUS                         | READ FROM           |
|---------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|---------------------|
| Wellbeing                 | The package is stated to lead on mental wellbeing, and no Employee Assistance Programme shows in your responses.                                                                                                                                               | <b>Short of the stated aim</b> | Your stated answers |
| Governance & transparency | Pay is described as fully open, and pay is never included in job adverts (Never, your response).                                                                                                                                                               | <b>Contradicted</b>            | Your stated answers |
| Governance & transparency | Pay information is stated as shared internally, and pay bands are not visible to employees (No, your response).                                                                                                                                                | <b>Contradicted</b>            | Your stated answers |
| Pay                       | The stated objective is attracting the people you need, and pay — the part of the package a candidate weighs first — is aimed below market. The two intents pull in opposite directions, and the employer brand is left doing the work pay is declining to do. | <b>Contradicted</b>            | Your stated answers |

### WHAT WE TESTED AND IT HELD

2 of your 13 commitments were tested against your own answers and stand: cash-led reward mix and location-agnostic pay. A further 1 holds on the market read rather than on your answers, and is marked as such in the register. Nothing here needs a decision — a commitment that was checked and held is evidence too, and only the register shows the difference between that and one nobody has looked at.

"Off strategy" counts the short, the contradicted and the past-aim rows together; the status column is the split. A commitment is one stated position or one coherence check — the same measure the cover, the executive summary and Part B count. Separately, the sections count 263 benchmarked readings from the core set's answered questions — a matrix question contributes one reading per role level.

09

## Findings (1 of 2)

Where the declared strategy and the live position diverge, and what organisations in this position commonly consider.

### Wellbeing is below market — short of the position you set for it

7 of 18 Wellbeing metrics sit below market.



Of 18 metrics benchmarked here: 7 below market, 9 on market, 2 above market.

### Incentives & recognition is below market — short of the position you set for it

6 of 17 Incentives & recognition metrics sit below market.



Of 17 metrics benchmarked here: 6 below market, 11 on market.

### Pensions & savings is below market — short of the position you set for it

15 of 32 Pensions & savings metrics sit below market; about £27,000 would move employer pension contribution to the peer median.



Of 32 metrics benchmarked here: 15 below market, 16 on market, 1 above market.

09

## Findings (2 of 2)

### Benefits & lifestyle is below market — short of the position you set for it

18 of 37 Benefits & lifestyle metrics sit below market.



Of 37 metrics benchmarked here: 18 below market, 17 on market, 2 above market.

Health & protection is tracking with the stated intent.

Pay and Time off & family sit above a deliberately lower aim — an aim-setting question rather than a delivery gap, taken up in their own sections.

### WHAT SITS ABOVE MARKET

- Wellbeing budget per employee — 77th percentile (Annual wellbeing budget per employee — £150 vs £103 peer median), on the 127 comparable organisations that answered it
- Promotion decision governance — 93rd percentile (100/100 vs 67/100 peer median), on the 258 comparable organisations that answered it

These are reads, not recommendations: an area above market may be exactly where the strategy wants it, or may be spend the strategy never asked for. Where it is past your own stated aim, its section says so.

10

Pay

How Pay sits against All peers, and what your strategy asks of it.

46

METRICS BENCHMARKED

typically 223 comparable organisations each (91–270)

on market

MARKET POSITION

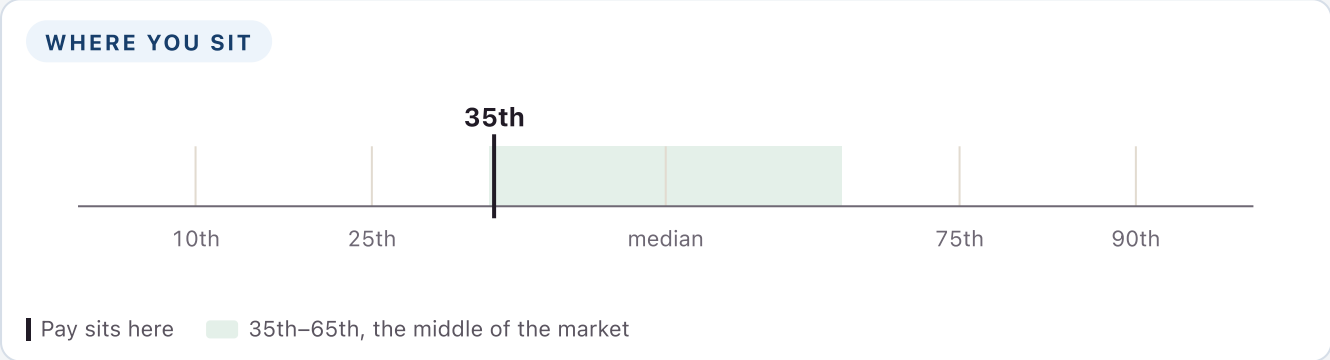
around the 35th percentile

above strategy

AGAINST YOUR AIM

you aim below market

Of 46 metrics benchmarked here: 12 below market, 31 on market, 3 above market.



**How this reads**

Pay reads on market overall, around the 35th percentile of All peers, on 46 benchmarked metrics with a median of 223 comparable organisations behind each. Of those, 12 sit below market, 31 sit on it and 3 sit above. You aim below market here; the live read sits past that aim. What follows sets out the options against that difference.

What Pay is flagging (1 of 9)

EXHIBIT 5 Signals in Pay, with your value and how each one reads against All peers

| SIGNAL                                                          | YOURS           | READS        |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|--------------|
| Salary increase budget                                          | 30th percentile | below market |
| Salary increase budget as % of payroll — 3% vs 3.4% peer median |                 |              |

The signal above is the most material in Pay, which is not the same as the most representative: it does not read on market, while the area overall does. The split at the top of this page is the fuller picture.

The remaining 8 signals are set out in full under Pay in the app.



Pay — what follows

The gaps Pay opens against your stated position, and the options the market commonly uses to close them — each with what it costs you elsewhere.

THE GAPS

You aim below market on Pay; the live read sits past it — spend beyond the stated position.

The stated objective is attracting the people you need, and pay — the part of the package a candidate weighs first — is aimed below market. The two intents pull in opposite directions, and the employer brand is left doing the work pay is declining to do.

EXHIBIT 6 Options against the Pay gaps

| OPTION                                                                                                                                      | COST         | SPEED                         | TRADE-OFF                                                                                                                       |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|-------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Formal pay bands with published progression</b><br>Defined salary ranges per grade, with the rules for moving through them written down. | cost-neutral | next cycle<br>hard to reverse | Bands surface every existing anomaly the day they are shared, so correction cases arrive with the release rather than after it. |
| <b>Merit matrix for the annual review</b><br>Pay increases set by the combination of performance rating and position in range.              | cost-neutral | next cycle                    | Only as credible as the performance ratings feeding it — rating inflation quietly flattens the differentiation it promises.     |

Pensions & savings

How Pensions & savings sits against All peers, and what your strategy asks of it.

32

METRICS BENCHMARKED

typically 270 comparable organisations each (267–270)

below market

MARKET POSITION

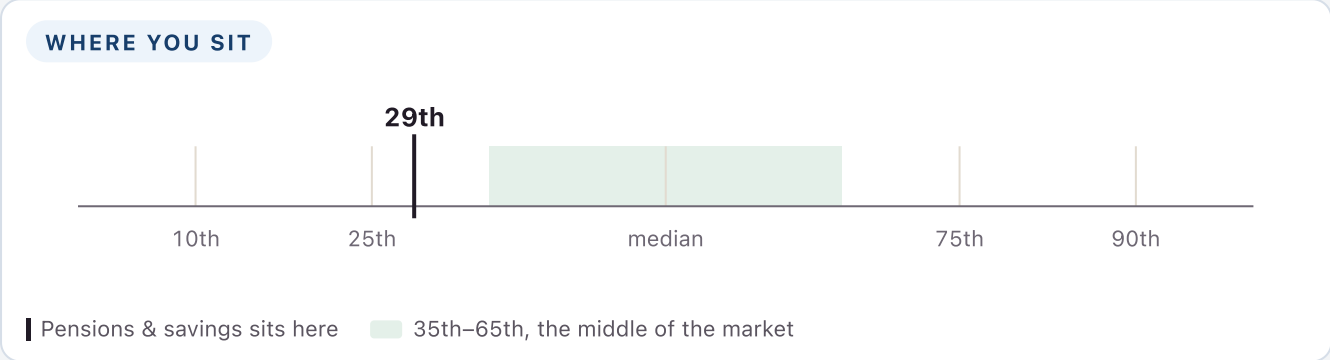
around the 29th percentile

below strategy

AGAINST YOUR AIM

you aim on market

Of 32 metrics benchmarked here: 15 below market, 16 on market, 1 above market.



**How this reads**

Pensions & savings reads below market overall, around the 29th percentile of All peers, on 32 benchmarked metrics with a median of 270 comparable organisations behind each. Of those, 15 sit below market, 16 sit on it and 1 sits above. You aim on market here; the live read sits short of that aim. What follows sets out the options against that difference.

What Pensions & savings is flagging (1 of 9)

EXHIBIT 7 Signals in Pensions & savings, with your value and how each one reads against All peers

| SIGNAL                                                                    | YOURS      | READS  |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|--------|
| <b>Employer pension (Board / Executive)</b>                               | 11th       | below  |
| Maximum employer pension contribution rate by level — Board / Executive — | percentile | market |
| 18% vs 20% peer median                                                    |            |        |

The remaining 8 signals are set out in full under Pensions & savings in the app.

## 11

## Pensions & savings — what follows

The gaps Pensions & savings opens against your stated position, and the options the market commonly uses to close them — each with what it costs you elsewhere.

### THE GAP

You aim on market on Pensions & savings; the live read sits short of it.

### EXHIBIT 8 Options against the Pensions & savings gaps

| OPTION                                                                                                                                                                 | COST      | SPEED                         | TRADE-OFF                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|-------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>A higher employer contribution</b><br>Raising what the employer puts in beyond its current rate towards the market's, either across the board or at defined levels. | recurring | next cycle<br>hard to reverse | Pension spend is rarely weighed by candidates at offer stage, and reducing employer contributions later means consultation and a real goodwill cost — it buys retention far better than attraction. |
| <b>A matching structure</b><br>Employer contributions that rise with what the employee chooses to put in, up to a stated ceiling.                                      | recurring | next cycle<br>hard to reverse | Matching rewards those who can afford to save, so it widens the gap between higher and lower earners unless the default is set generously.                                                          |
| <b>Financial wellbeing support</b><br>Guidance, tools or workplace saving that help people manage money now, alongside the pension that pays later.                    | one-off   | this cycle                    | Support is judged on whether it changes anything; offered without follow-through it reads as a gesture.                                                                                             |

12

## Health & protection

How Health & protection sits against All peers, and what your strategy asks of it.

**16****METRICS BENCHMARKED**

typically 267 comparable organisations each (188–270)

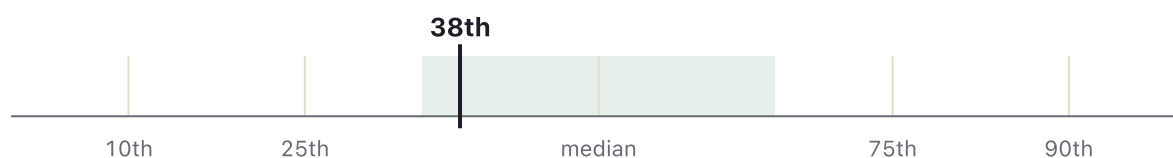
**on market****MARKET POSITION**

around the 38th percentile

**on strategy****AGAINST YOUR AIM**

you aim on market

Of 16 metrics benchmarked here: 15 on market, 1 above market.

**WHERE YOU SIT****How this reads**

Health & protection reads on market overall, around the 38th percentile of All peers, on 16 benchmarked metrics with a median of 267 comparable organisations behind each. Of those, 15 sit on it and 1 sits above. You aim on market here; the live read matches that aim.

Nothing in Health & protection currently runs against your stated aim.

## Benefits & lifestyle

How Benefits & lifestyle sits against All peers, and what your strategy asks of it.

37

METRICS BENCHMARKED

typically 251 comparable organisations each (196–270)

below market

MARKET POSITION

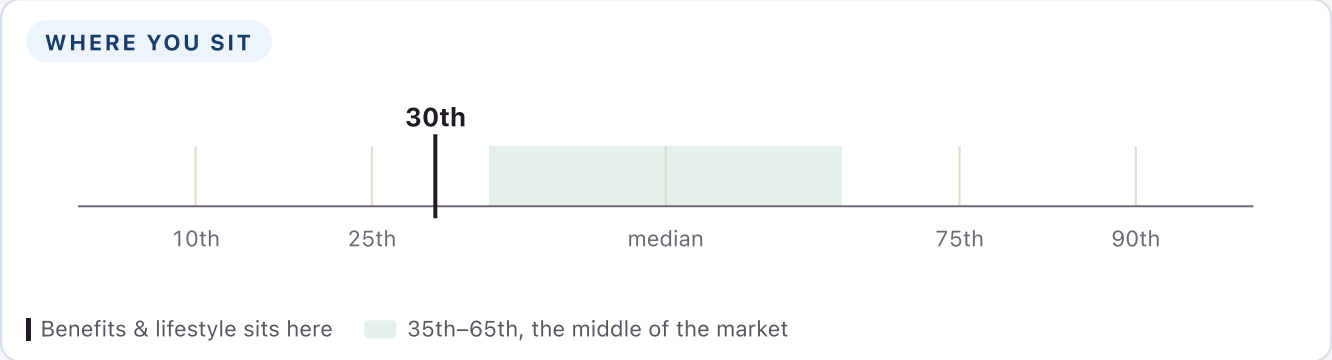
around the 30th percentile

below strategy

AGAINST YOUR AIM

you aim on market

Of 37 metrics benchmarked here: 18 below market, 17 on market, 2 above market.



**How this reads**

Benefits & lifestyle reads below market overall, around the 30th percentile of All peers, on 37 benchmarked metrics with a median of 251 comparable organisations behind each. Of those, 18 sit below market, 17 sit on it and 2 sit above. You aim on market here; the live read sits short of that aim. What follows sets out the options against that difference.

What Benefits & lifestyle is flagging (1 of 9)

EXHIBIT 9 Signals in Benefits & lifestyle, with your value and how each one reads against All peers

| SIGNAL                                                                        | YOURS      | READS  |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|--------|
| <b>Flexible benefits allowance (Board / Executive)</b>                        | 2nd        | below  |
| Annual flexible benefits allowance by level % of base pay — Board / Executive | percentile | market |
| — 0.8% vs 2.7% peer median                                                    |            |        |

The remaining 8 signals are set out in full under Benefits & lifestyle in the app.

13

## Benefits & lifestyle — what follows (1 of 2)

The gaps Benefits & lifestyle opens against your stated position, and the options the market commonly uses to close them — each with what it costs you elsewhere.

### THE GAPS

You aim on market on Benefits & lifestyle; the live read sits short of it.

The package is stated to lead on financial wellbeing, and neither a financial-wellbeing programme nor default salary-sacrifice pension shows in your responses.

### EXHIBIT 10 Options against the Benefits & lifestyle gaps (1 of 2)

| OPTION                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | COST         | SPEED                          | TRADE-OFF                                                                                                                                                                         |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|--------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Flexible benefits allowance</b><br>A per-employee allowance spent across a menu of benefits instead of one fixed package.                                                                                                                               | recurring    | multi-cycle<br>hard to reverse | Platform and administration costs are real and permanent; take-up disappoints where communication is thin.                                                                        |
| <b>Salary-sacrifice arrangements</b><br>Benefits funded from gross pay where the tax rules still allow it — pension, cycle-to-work, ultra-low-emission cars — with automatic-enrolment compliance preserved and pay never sacrificed below the wage floor. | cost-saving  | next cycle                     | Since the 2017 rules most other benefits lost the advantage, and the employer chooses whether to share its NI saving; announced NIC changes may cap the pension saving in future. |
| <b>Group risk bundle</b><br>Life assurance, income protection and critical illness bought together as an insured bundle.                                                                                                                                   | recurring    | next cycle                     | At this workforce size schemes are typically unit-rated, so premiums move with workforce age, profile and market rates at each review — the cost is not fixed at purchase.        |
| <b>Voluntary benefits platform</b><br>Employee-paid benefits at group rates — discounts, insurance top-ups, financial products — at low employer cost.                                                                                                     | cost-neutral | this cycle                     | Perceived value is far below paid benefits — it widens choice, it does not read as investment.                                                                                    |

Benefits & lifestyle — what follows (2 of 2)

EXHIBIT 11 Options against the Benefits & lifestyle gaps (2 of 2)

| OPTION                                                                                                                                             | COST         | SPEED      | TRADE-OFF                                                                                                                                              |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>A stated benefits position</b><br>Setting out what the package is meant to lead on, so provision reads as a choice rather than an accumulation. | cost-neutral | this cycle | Naming what the package leads on also names what it does not, which is a harder conversation in a year with no budget.                                 |
| <b>Benefits communication and take-up</b><br>Making existing provision visible and easy to use, rather than buying more of it.                     | cost-neutral | this cycle | Communication raises the perceived value of what exists and does nothing for a benefit that is genuinely missing — it cannot substitute for provision. |

14

## Time off & family

How Time off & family sits against All peers, and what your strategy asks of it.

43

### METRICS BENCHMARKED

typically 257 comparable organisations each (134–268)

on market

### MARKET POSITION

around the 39th percentile

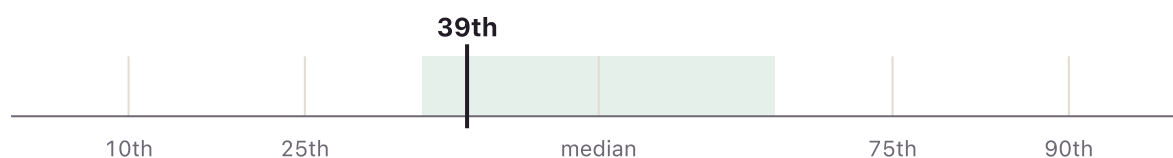
above strategy

### AGAINST YOUR AIM

you aim below market

Of 43 metrics benchmarked here: 11 below market, 24 on market, 8 above market.

### WHERE YOU SIT



Time off & family sits here 35th–65th, the middle of the market

### How this reads

Time off & family reads on market overall, around the 39th percentile of All peers, on 43 benchmarked metrics with a median of 257 comparable organisations behind each. Of those, 11 sit below market, 24 sit on it and 8 sit above. You aim below market here; the live read sits past that aim. Sitting past your own aim is not closed by adding to the package, so the section that follows sets out why rather than what to add.

Time off & family is flagging 9 signals; they are set out in full under Time off & family in the app.

### What follows for Time off & family

You aim below market on Time off & family; the live read sits past it — spend beyond the stated position.

Time off & family already sits above this aim, so every lever in the inventory would add to a package that is ahead of the stated position — the open question is whether the aim itself still reads right.



15

## Incentives & recognition

How Incentives & recognition sits against All peers, and what your strategy asks of it.

17

METRICS BENCHMARKED

typically 270 comparable organisations each (169–270)

below market

MARKET POSITION

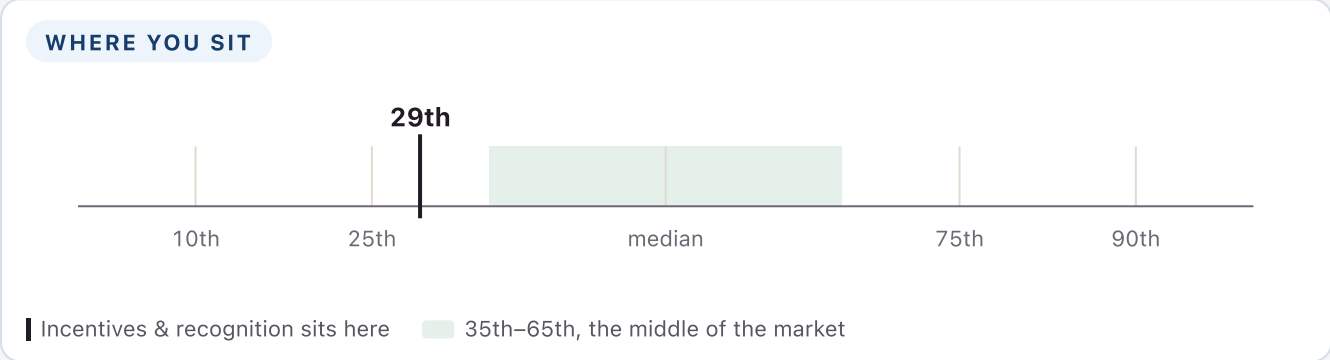
around the 29th percentile

below strategy

AGAINST YOUR AIM

you aim above market

Of 17 metrics benchmarked here: 6 below market, 11 on market.



**How this reads**

Incentives & recognition reads below market overall, around the 29th percentile of All peers, on 17 benchmarked metrics with a median of 270 comparable organisations behind each. Of those, 6 sit below market and 11 sit on it. You aim above market here; the live read sits short of that aim. What follows sets out the options against that difference.

What Incentives & recognition is flagging (1 of 4)

EXHIBIT 12 Signals in Incentives & recognition, with your value and how each one reads against All peers

| SIGNAL                                                                                     | YOURS           | READS        |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|--------------|
| <b>Long-service award value</b>                                                            | 14th percentile | below market |
| Typical value of a long service award at the main milestone — 25/100 vs 75/100 peer median |                 |              |

The remaining 3 signals are set out in full under Incentives & recognition in the app.

15

## Incentives & recognition — what follows

The gaps Incentives & recognition opens against your stated position, and the options the market commonly uses to close them — each with what it costs you elsewhere.

### THE GAP

You aim above market on Incentives & recognition; the live read sits short of it.

### EXHIBIT 13 Options against the Incentives & recognition gaps

| OPTION                                                                                                                                                                                               | COST      | SPEED                         | TRADE-OFF                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|-------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>A defined annual bonus plan</b><br>A written variable-pay plan with a named population, a target percentage and the measures it pays against.                                                     | recurring | next cycle<br>hard to reverse | Once a target percentage is published people plan around it, so a lean year reads as a cut rather than a variable outcome.                                                                 |
| <b>A non-cash recognition scheme</b><br>A structured way for colleagues and managers to mark good work, usually with vouchers, points or awards rather than salary.                                  | recurring | this cycle                    | An annual award budget, not a one-off: voucher and points awards are taxable earnings unless each sits within the trivial-benefits exemption, so the real cost includes the tax treatment. |
| <b>Uplifting existing award values</b><br>Raising the value of awards the organisation already makes — long-service, recognition, milestone — to the level peers pay, without adding any new scheme. | recurring | this cycle<br>hard to reverse | Raising a visible award value is a public benchmark for every later award — values are easy to lift and painful to lower, and the spend recurs with every qualifying employee.             |

16

## Wellbeing

How Wellbeing sits against All peers, and what your strategy asks of it.

18

METRICS BENCHMARKED

typically 267 comparable organisations each (127–270)

below market

MARKET POSITION

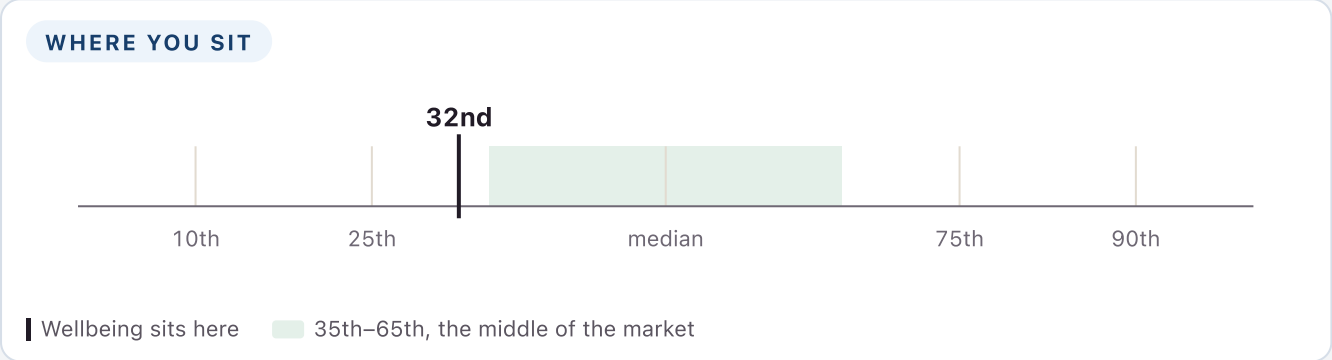
around the 32nd percentile

below strategy

AGAINST YOUR AIM

you aim above market

Of 18 metrics benchmarked here: 7 below market, 9 on market, 2 above market.



**How this reads**

Wellbeing reads below market overall, around the 32nd percentile of All peers, on 18 benchmarked metrics with a median of 267 comparable organisations behind each. Of those, 7 sit below market, 9 sit on it and 2 sit above. You aim above market here; the live read sits short of that aim. What follows sets out the options against that difference.

What Wellbeing is flagging (1 of 5)

EXHIBIT 14 Signals in Wellbeing, with your value and how each one reads against All peers

| SIGNAL                                                                       | YOURS | READS        |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------|--------------|
| Employee assistance programme                                                | 72%   | below market |
| of the comparison pool employee Assistance Programme offered — you don't yet |       |              |

The remaining 4 signals are set out in full under Wellbeing in the app.

16

## Wellbeing — what follows

The gaps Wellbeing opens against your stated position, and the options the market commonly uses to close them — each with what it costs you elsewhere.

### THE GAP

The package is stated to lead on mental wellbeing, and no Employee Assistance Programme shows in your responses.

### EXHIBIT 15 Options against the Wellbeing gaps

| OPTION                                                                                                                                                                | COST         | SPEED      | TRADE-OFF                                                                                                                                        |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>An employee assistance programme</b><br>A confidential support line and short-course counselling, available to employees and usually their households.             | recurring    | this cycle | Take-up is low everywhere unless it is promoted repeatedly, so the cost is small and the visible return is slow.                                 |
| <b>Named mental health support</b><br>Trained first-contact colleagues, manager guidance, and a route to clinical help that people can find without asking a manager. | one-off      | this cycle | Trained colleagues carry real weight for others; without supervision and a clear boundary the support becomes a burden they did not sign up for. |
| <b>A stated wellbeing framework</b><br>Setting out what the organisation covers and what it does not, so provision reads as a position rather than a collection.      | cost-neutral | this cycle | A framework makes the gaps as visible as the provision, which is useful internally and uncomfortable in a year with no budget to fill them.      |
| <b>Manager capability on wellbeing</b><br>Equipping managers to hold the early conversation and to know where it goes next.                                           | one-off      | next cycle | This is the lever with the widest reach and the least visible output — it shows up in absence and turnover long before anyone credits it.        |

17

## Governance & transparency

How Governance & transparency sits against All peers, and what your strategy asks of it.

54

METRICS BENCHMARKED

typically 270 comparable organisations each (229–270)

on market

MARKET POSITION

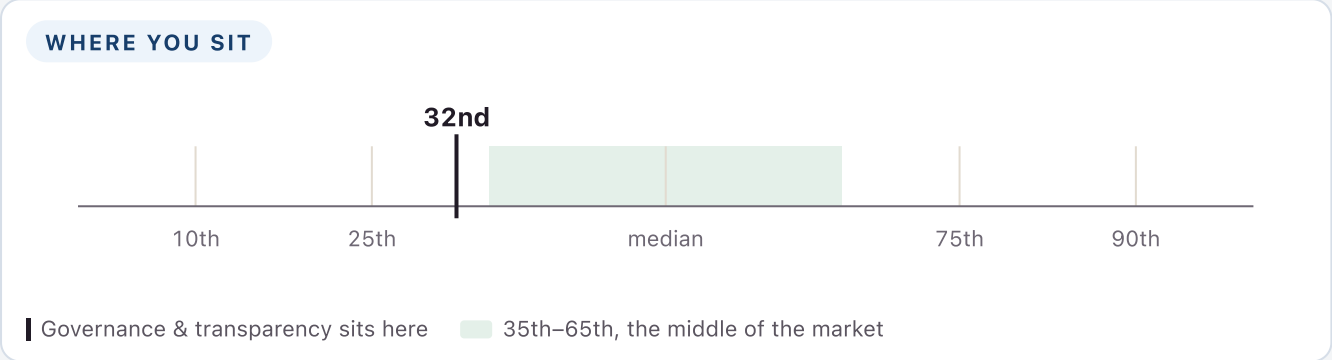
around the 32nd percentile

below strategy

AGAINST YOUR AIM

you aim above market

Of 54 metrics benchmarked here: 18 below market, 29 on market, 7 above market.



**How this reads**

Governance & transparency reads on market overall, around the 32nd percentile of All peers, on 54 benchmarked metrics with a median of 270 comparable organisations behind each. Of those, 18 sit below market, 29 sit on it and 7 sit above. You aim above market here; the live read sits short of that aim. What follows sets out the options against that difference.

What Governance & transparency is flagging (1 of 10)

EXHIBIT 16 Signals in Governance & transparency, with your value and how each one reads against All peers

| SIGNAL                                                                     | YOURS      | READS  |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|--------|
| Maximum promotion increase                                                 | 22nd       | below  |
| Typical maximum pay increase for promotions — 25/100 vs 50/100 peer median | percentile | market |

The signal above is the most material in Governance & transparency, which is not the same as the most representative: it does not read on market, while the area overall does. The split at the top of this page is the fuller picture.

The remaining 9 signals are set out in full under Governance & transparency in the app.

17

## Governance & transparency — what follows

The gaps Governance & transparency opens against your stated position, and the options the market commonly uses to close them — each with what it costs you elsewhere.

### THE GAPS

Pay is described as fully open, and pay is never included in job adverts (Never, your response).

Pay information is stated as shared internally, and pay bands are not visible to employees (No, your response).

### EXHIBIT 17 Options against the Governance & transparency gaps

| OPTION                                                                                                                                    | COST         | SPEED                         | TRADE-OFF                                                                                                                                               |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|-------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Publishing pay ranges internally</b><br>Making the range for a role visible to the people in it, with the rules for moving through it. | one-off      | next cycle<br>hard to reverse | Publishing ranges surfaces every anomaly at once, so the correction budget and the manager script are load-bearing on the day of release, not after it. |
| <b>Pay ranges in job adverts</b><br>Stating the range on the advert rather than at offer stage.                                           | cost-neutral | this cycle                    | Candidates self-select on the number before they hear anything else, which shortens hiring and loses some people who would have been persuadable.       |
| <b>A fixed pay review cycle</b><br>A published annual timetable for how pay is reviewed, decided and communicated.                        | cost-neutral | next cycle                    | A fixed cycle ends ad-hoc rises, which is the point and also the thing managers will miss most in the first year.                                       |



## PART C

# What follows

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The actions the gaps in Part B lead to, sequenced across cycles — with what they cost, what they expose the organisation to, and a record of the options that were weighed and not taken.

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|                          |    |
|--------------------------|----|
| 18 The schedule          | 32 |
| 19 The plan              | 34 |
| 20 What it costs         | 35 |
| 21 What a point is worth | 36 |
| 22 Risks and exposures   | 37 |

18

## The schedule (1 of 2)

The same actions as the section that follows, grouped by when each one can realistically land.

4 actions across 3 horizons, sequenced by how quickly each one can realistically land. They are not 4 separate commitments: every one is an option against a single gap — one option per gap in any one cycle; where two sit in the same cycle they are alternatives, one of them, not both. 1 sits in the current cycle; the rest are held deliberately, not deferred by omission.

**This cycle**

1 action

**Next cycle**

2 actions

**Multi-cycle**

1 action

**Voluntary benefits platform**

Benefits & lifestyle

**Salary-sacrifice arrangements**

Benefits & lifestyle

**Flexible benefits allowance**

Benefits & lifestyle

**Group risk bundle**

Benefits & lifestyle

All 4 actions in the plan, placed by the horizon recorded against each one. The order within a column is the order they are set out below.

**EXHIBIT 18** Planned actions by horizon (1 of 2)

| ACTION                                                                                    | AREA                       | RETURN                                                                                 |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b><u>This cycle</u></b> 1 action                                                         |                            |                                                                                        |
| <b>Voluntary benefits platform</b>                                                        | Benefits & lifestyle (§13) | No indicative figure — the effect is on retention, fairness and how the package reads. |
| <b><u>Next cycle</u></b> 2 actions                                                        |                            |                                                                                        |
| <b>Salary-sacrifice arrangements</b>                                                      | Benefits & lifestyle (§13) | Cost-saving where it lands.                                                            |
| <b>Group risk bundle</b><br>either/or with Salary-sacrifice arrangements — one of the two | Benefits & lifestyle (§13) | No indicative figure — the effect is on retention, fairness and how the package reads. |



The schedule (2 of 2)

EXHIBIT 19 Planned actions by horizon (2 of 2)

| ACTION                             | AREA                       | RETURN                                                                                 |
|------------------------------------|----------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Multi-cycle</b> 1 action        |                            |                                                                                        |
| <b>Flexible benefits allowance</b> | Benefits & lifestyle (§13) | No indicative figure — the effect is on retention, fairness and how the package reads. |

Options against one gap are one decision stream — Benefits & lifestyle carries 4. A later option returns to the board in its own cycle, read against what the earlier change moved; approving one never pre-commits the rest.

19

## The plan

This is the roll-up of the sections above: every action below is one of the options already set out under its own area, sequenced across all of them.

4 actions follow from the gaps between your stated strategy and your own data.

**1. Voluntary benefits platform · one of 4 options against this gap · from Benefits & lifestyle (§13) · this cycle**

You aim on market on Benefits & lifestyle; the live read sits short of it. Employee-paid benefits at group rates — discounts, insurance top-ups, financial products — at low employer cost.

**RETURN** No indicative figure — the effect is on retention, fairness and how the package reads.

**2. Salary-sacrifice arrangements · one of 4 options against this gap · from Benefits & lifestyle (§13) · next cycle**

Benefits funded from gross pay where the tax rules still allow it — pension, cycle-to-work, ultra-low-emission cars — with automatic-enrolment compliance preserved and pay never sacrificed below the wage floor.

**RETURN** Cost-saving where it lands.

**3. Group risk bundle · either/or with Salary-sacrifice arrangements — one of the two · from Benefits & lifestyle (§13) · next cycle**

Life assurance, income protection and critical illness bought together as an insured bundle.

**RETURN** No indicative figure — the effect is on retention, fairness and how the package reads.

**4. Flexible benefits allowance · one of 4 options against this gap · from Benefits & lifestyle (§13) · multi-cycle**

A per-employee allowance spent across a menu of benefits instead of one fixed package.

**RETURN** No indicative figure — the effect is on retention, fairness and how the package reads.

Built from the gaps between your stated strategy and your own data, on All peers. Indicative figures come from lumi's £ model with its published assumptions. Built 15 Aug 2026.

20

## What it costs

What closing these gaps costs, as far as lumi can price it on All peers.

**£27,000**

INDICATIVE INVESTMENT, A  
YEAR

to reach the peer median

**None**

INDICATIVE SAVING, A YEAR

no priced metric sits above the peer  
median

**1 of 10**

GAPS PRICED

lumi's cost model, published  
assumptions

Closing the gaps lumi can price to the peer median is an indicative £27,000 a year. That envelope covers 1 of the 10 gaps in this review: the remainder are changes lumi does not price, and their cost has to be modelled by you rather than read off a benchmark. Aggregate £ figures round to the nearest thousand and per-person figures to the pound; every £ here is indicative on these assumptions, whether or not the word sits beside it. Figures use the midpoint of your stated FTE band (50–249 FTE, midpoint 150) and lumi's published salary and level-mix assumptions. Peer rates are medians of All peers, which spans organisations of every size — the £ scales on your headcount while the rates reflect that sample. They are an order of magnitude for a board discussion, not a budget.

### Where the figure comes from

**EXHIBIT 20** Metrics lumi can price, and the cost of moving each to the peer median

| METRIC                                                                                     | AREA       | TO MEDIAN | TO UPPER QUARTILE |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|-----------|-------------------|
| <b>Employer pension contribution</b>                                                       | Pensions & | £27,000   | £81,000           |
| summed level by level: the gap to the peer rate<br>× median salary × the FTE in that level | savings    |           |                   |

### The assumptions behind it

Median salary £36,000 and your headcount (150 FTE, the midpoint of your stated 50–249 band) drive every figure above. Cost per leaver (35% of salary) and the agency premium (30%) apply only where attrition or agency metrics are priced. Contribution gaps are priced on full salary; where contributions are set on qualifying earnings the true cost is lower, so the envelope reads as an upper indication rather than a like-for-like cost. Change any input in your company details and the figures move with it.

## 21

## What a point is worth

What a single percentage point of movement is worth on your own headcount — 150 FTE, the midpoint of your stated band. The multiplier for the actions lumi cannot price.

9 of the 10 gaps in this review carry no price lumi can model — their effect is on retention, fairness and how the package reads. That is true and, on its own, useless to a board weighing one against another. lumi cannot say how much of that effect an action buys. It can say what a single percentage point is worth on your own headcount, in the two currencies those actions trade in — so the board weighs a change against a number it already recognises.

**EXHIBIT 21** What one percentage point of movement is worth, and the arithmetic behind each

| MOVE                                               | WORTH, A YEAR | HOW IT IS WORKED OUT                                           |
|----------------------------------------------------|---------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>One percentage point of regretted attrition</b> | £18,900       | 1% of 150 FTE × cost per leaver (35% of £36,000 median salary) |
| <b>One percentage point of agency usage</b>        | £16,200       | 1% of 150 FTE × £36,000 median salary × 30% agency premium     |

These rates are on total headcount, not weighted by level — the gap figures under What it costs are level-weighted, so these are a scale check rather than a way to work backwards to a gap. lumi does not say how many points any action buys — that would be a prediction about your organisation it has no basis for. It states the arithmetic of one point; the judgement about how many an action is worth stays with the board.

## Risks and exposures

What this review found that bears on delivery, affordability or the strength of the evidence.

The exposures below are restatements of what this review found, not forecasts. Each names a condition that is true of the organisation today and says what it bears on; none of them is a recommendation, and how binding each one is stays a judgement for the board.

### EXPOSURE

**Pensions & savings, Benefits & lifestyle, Incentives & recognition and Wellbeing below the market on a stated aim to match or lead**

Each of these sits below the peer group on lumi's read while the strategy aims at or above it. That is a live gap between what candidates and employees encounter and what the organisation says it offers, for as long as it stands.

### EVIDENCE

**There is no prior period to measure movement against**

This is lumi's first aggregated collection window, so every figure here is a baseline. Whether a position is improving or slipping cannot be evidenced until a second window closes, and no reading in this document should be taken as a direction of travel.

### STATUTORY

**The statutory wage floor moves every April, and your stated pay aim sits in the lower half of the market**

In this sector the National Living Wage commonly sets the floor for a large share of roles. Each April uplift compresses differentials above it and narrows the room a lower-half pay position has to exist at all. No read in this document uses a sector cut, and lumi cannot see your rate headroom over the floor or how much of your workforce sits near it — how much of the annual uplift lands as unavoidable spend is a judgement only you can make.

lumi can only name exposures its own data shows. Anything outside the benchmark — delivery capacity, employee relations, what a competitor is about to do — is not in view here and its absence is not evidence of its absence.

# Governance and approval

Who approved this strategy — and what was left unstated at the point of approval.

APPROVAL RECORD

EXHIBIT 22 Approval record for this strategy

|                   |                                                                                                           |
|-------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Status            | <b>Approved</b> — amended 15 Aug 2026; the amendments await re-approval                                   |
| Version           | <b>1</b>                                                                                                  |
| Approved by       | <b>director@thornbridge.example</b><br>the approving account; no board or committee was named at approval |
| Strategy captured | <b>17 Jun 2026</b>                                                                                        |

Every read in this document is taken against the strategy as it stands today — the amended statement, not the earlier approved version. Re-approval of the amendments is recorded here when it happens.

Produced with lumi · reward benchmarking. Comparison pool: 270 UK organisation profiles. See [lumihr.co.uk](https://lumihr.co.uk) methodology for sources. All written commentary uses lumi's standard wording.